

Hygiene Fire Protection District
BOARD OF DIRECTORS REGULAR MEETING
Fire Station, 7523 Hygiene Road
Wednesday, January 14, 2026, at 7:00 p.m.

This meeting was conducted virtually via Microsoft Teams teleconferencing software. Rachel Arellano was the meeting host.

Directors in Attendance: Rick Hill, and Tony Lewis, Gordon Russell, and Marc Smerekanicz

Directors Not in Attendance: Rich Hanke

Department Personnel: District Administrator Rachel Arellano, Chief Alex Frank

Meeting Attendees: None

€ PENSION BOARD – None

€ CALL REGULAR MEETING OF HFPD BOARD TO ORDER - Regular meeting called to order at 7:05 p.m.

€ AUDIENCE COMMENTS FOR ITEMS NOT ON AGENDA - None

€ APPROVE MINUTES

a. Regular Meeting Minutes, December 10, 2025

- i. Director Lewis made a MOTION to approve December 10, 2025, Regular Meeting Minutes. Director Smerekanicz seconded. Director Russell abstained because he was not present. The motion was approved by majority vote.

€ REPORTS

a. President's Report – None

b. Treasurer's Report

- i. Review and approve budget message for 2026
 - a) Director Lewis reviews the 2026 budget message. Will continue to work on it and will send it out via email to the board for an online vote.

- b) Review YTD financials
 - (1) Director Lewis reviews YTD financials. Still missing a few items for a complete picture but hoping to have it completed by end of the month so we can review at next meeting.
- c) Review and approve three-year budget:
 - (1) Director Lewis is working to finalize.
- d) Review and approve 2026 Pension Budget
 - (1) Discussion held regarding pension duties. Director Russell will start taking over pension tasks and will review w/ Chair Hanke and Director Lewis.
- e) Approve resolution naming Tony Lewis as Treasurer of the Board with the authorization to open and close bank accounts and credit card accounts
 - (1) Director Lewis reviews issues with an old BMO account. In order to close the account, BMO needs a new resolution giving Director Lewis authorization to close it.
 - (2) Director Russell made a MOTION to authorize Tony Lewis, as Treasurer of the Board, to open and close bank accounts and credit card accounts. Director Smerekianicz seconded, and the motion was approved by unanimous vote.
- f) Communications plan
 - (1) Chief Frank reviews Amy Guttman's scope of work as an educational campaign and continuing outreach to the community. A discussion was held regarding keeping community informed (red flag warnings, etc.), keeping yearly events (pancake supper, festival), posts about big incidents, community meetings and trainings, and updates regarding the building.
 - (2) Chief Frank proposes possibility of an electronic sign outside of the building. Discussion held regarding the benefits and cost..
 - (3) Director Lewis circles back to communications proposal – how much do we want to do, can we do, contracting it out. Chief Frank, Director Lewis and Rachel to have a meeting,

look at the plan together, and come up with plan of what is feasible and what outside help we need and bring to February board meeting.

- c. Secretary's Report - None
- d. Friends of Hygiene - None
- e. Chief's Report
 - i. Chief Frank reviews calls and staffing for the year 2025:
 - a) 113 medical, 5 structure, 16 wildland, 1 car fire, 41 MVA, 84 good intent/false/canceled, 15 gas leak, 11 powerline down. 2025 total: 286
 - b) Shift Coverage – Lieutenants 99.2%, Firefighters 100%, Stipend Volunteer 49.3%, s860 \$86.5%.
 - ii. Highlights in 2025
 - a) ISO rating improved from ISO 5 to ISO 4; successful mill levy increase; hired three battalion chiefs, third paid spot implemented; wildland deployment brought in roughly \$120k in profit.
 - iii. Projects
 - a) Chief Frank and Director Smerekancicz give update on the power pole with LPC. It is more cost-efficient to wait until project starts and the property is excavated.
 - b) Chief Frank gives an update on the tree trimming proposal and powerline with the neighbor to the east. Chief has talked with the family/property manager and received verbal consent to cut the trees and declined written form. Chief reviews the powerline/pole and the need to go underground with the powerline to her house and also received verbal consent. A written statement/agreement about this is necessary for LPC. Going overhead is not an option due to the chimney.
 - c) Informational letter to Hygiene citizens - Director Lewis is still wanting to send out an informational letter to citizens. Director Lewis will revise the letter. Discussion held regarding the best form of delivery for the letter.

- d) Cemex is reviewing proposal for expanded training facility on their property. The proposal includes a wildland mitigation area for training purposes and for the benefit of Cemex.

iv. Action Items

- a) IGA with Lyons is done and signed and the MOU with AMR has been signed. Chief reviews the specifics of the agreement. The go live date is January 15th.
- b) Director Lewis reviews what needs to happen for the permit to be submitted for the camper to be in the bay. Chief Frank and Director Smerekianicz to meet about putting this together.
- c) LPC needs to be paid first for all services.

v. Miscellaneous

- a) Boulder County Grant 1B awarded \$195,380

vi. Training:

- a) January 15th (Thursday): Forcible Entry at Hygiene @ 1800
- b) January 20th (Tuesday): Garage Doors at Hygiene @ 0800
- c) January 25th (Sunday): K12 Cutting at Hygiene @ 1800

vii. Certifications

- a) Certs renewed

€ OLD BUSINESS - None

€ NEW BUSINESS

- a. Rachel Arellano requests signing authority for check payments. A discussion was held regarding financial controls and limits. Director Lewis made a MOTION to add Rachel Arellano as an authorized signer. Director Russell seconded, and the motion was approved by unanimous vote.
- b. Chief Frank reviews the replacement apparatus plan. Fort Lupton is getting rid of a reserve engine. Chief Frank has asked them to donate it to us. Hygiene's rig/trucks manager thinks it would be a good replacement. An option is to sell our reserve and use the proceeds to pay Fort Lupton for theirs. Director Lewis points out that there is 55k in CSAFE that can be used for a truck replacement.

€ AGENDA NEXT MONTH

- a. February 11th

€ ADJOURNMENT

- a. Russell Director Hanke made a MOTION to adjourn the meeting at 8:33 p.m. Director Smerekanicz seconded, and the motion was approved by unanimous vote.

MOTION/RESOLUTION SUMMARY:

- i. a MOTION to approve the December 10th Regular Meeting Minutes
- ii. a MOTION to authorize Director Lewis to open and close BMO accounts
- iii. a MOTION to add Rachel Arellano as an authorized signer on UMB accounts

ACTION ITEMS:-

Chief Frank – Meet w/ Director Smerekanicz to finalize permit for the camper in the bay;

Pension Board Chair Bashor - None

Chair Hanke – Meet w/ Director Russell and Director Lewis regarding pension duties

Director Hill – None

Director Lewis – Finalize budget message and send to Rachel to send to the board for an online vote; finalize three-year budget; meet w/ Director Russell and Chair Hanke regarding pension duties; add Rachel as authorized signer to UMB; close old BMO account

Director Russell – Work with Chair Hanke and Director Lewis regarding pension duties

Director Smerekanicz – Meet w/ Chief Frank to finalize permit for the camper in the bay;

District Administrator Arellano – Budget message voting; filed budget package; Get NextDoor login from Amy; Set a communications meeting w/ Chief Frank, Director Lewis, and Amy Guttman